



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Are you a poet in the making?



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write a small poem.
- I can write about feelings and reactions.
- I can express suggestions, necessity, and possibility.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you read poetry? Do you like it?
- What kinds of poetry are there? Does poetry always have to have rhythm?





Let's Explore!

Sally receives a mysterious letter in the mail? Who is it from?

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Hey, what's that?
Sally: I'm not sure. It's a letter of some kind.
Vanessa: Does the address look familiar? It might be from a long-lost relative.
Sally: Oh my goodness!
Vanessa: Calm down and let me see. Someone has written you a poem? Well ... that's different!
Sally: Wow ... This is from Christian from work. I think it's a Valentine's Day poem.
Vanessa: He wrote you a poem?
Sally: This is the sweetest thing I have ever read. It even rhymes. It's long too - 3 stanzas. This must have taken him ages. You could read it aloud for me.
Vanessa:
- My Valentine, you're all I see;
 In you, I find joy and delight;
 You make me all I can be;
 I'm happiest when I'm in your light.
- I dream of you both night and day;
 I'm drawn to you like the sun;
 When you're not here, my heart feels pain;
 You are the only one.
- I think of love like this, and smile;
 I never thought that I could obtain;
 The deep, excitement in my soul;
 Is something I can never explain.
- Sally:** How romantic! It's a shame that I'm not interested in him.
Vanessa: Sally, who is this guy? Granted he is a bit of a wordsmith but how well do you really know him? Does he have a bit of an obsession?
Sally: He might work in the accountant's department. I don't see him very often and when I do, he's quite shy.
Vanessa: It sounds like he has a crush on you. You may want to talk to him.
Sally: Should I call him or do you think it's better if I speak to him face to face?
Vanessa: I think you have to consider his feelings. You should let him down gently when you see him tomorrow.
Sally: I promise I won't crack up. That would be very unkind.





Let's Practice!

"What was the girls' reaction to the Valentine's Day poem? Should Sally confront* Christian or let him down** gently?

*""To confront"" means to challenge someone in a direct way.

**""To let someone down"" is a phrasal verb.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Write each word in the correct order. Say the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I / you / consider / have / to / feelings. / his / think
2. I / won't / crack / I / promise / up.
3. That / unkind. / would / very / be
4. down / him / see / Let / tomorrow. / when / gently / him / you
5. see. / Calm / and / me / down / let



Let's Practice!

Vanessa advises Sally on how to react to the poem. What does she suggest?

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Complete the sentences with the correct option.

1. It _____ be from a long lost relative.
2. You _____ want to talk to him.
3. I think you _____ to consider his feelings.
4. This _____ have taken him ages.
5. You _____ let him down easily.

have	should	want
might	u	may
must	does	can



Extension Activity

Let's explore different kinds of poetry.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find 3 short poems that you like.
- Complete the chart below.
- With a partner, describe the three poems you chose aloud.
- Use the modals *may*, *might* and *have to* when talking about the poems.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research poetry online.

☐ ☐

I complete a chart using research I collected.

☐ ☐

I can express possibilities and necessities when talking about poetry.

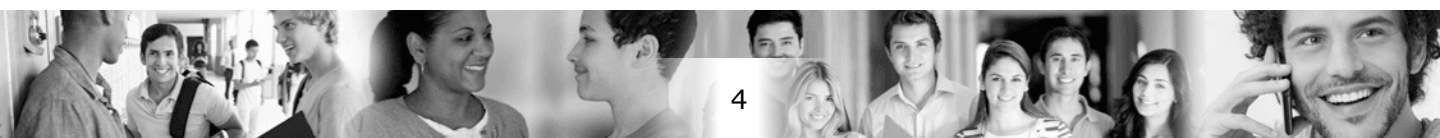
☐ ☐

Name of Poem	Author	Does The Poem Rhyme?	What Is The Poem About?
1.			
2.			
3.			



Target Words

- a long-lost relative** (expression): a person you have not seen or heard from in a long time
e.g. It might be from a long-lost relative.
- to calm down** (verb): to relax; to reduce anxiety
e.g. Calm down and let me see.
- to let someone down** (verb): to decline someone's interest
e.g. I hope you let him down easily.
- rhyme** (noun): one of two or more words or phrases that end in the same sounds
e.g. The poem even rhymes.
- stanza** (noun): a group of lines in a poem
e.g. There are three stanzas in the poem.
- wordsmith** (expression): a person who is very clever at writing
e.g. Christian is a bit of a wordsmith.
- obsession** (noun): someone or something you think about constantly or frequently
e.g. I hope I don't become an obsession of his.
- to crack up** (verb): to laugh, sometimes when inappropriate
e.g. Don't crack up when you speak with him.





Learning Points

What is a poem?

A poem is a piece of writing that is nearly always rhythmical, and often has elements such as meter, rhyme, and stanzas.

You write poetry to express your thoughts and ideas in a shorter form.

Sometimes, the end of each line can rhyme.

Here are some terms that you use when describing poetry.

Word	Definition
rhyme	one of two or more words or phrases that end in the same sounds
stanza	a group of lines in a poem
meter	a way of arranging the sounds or beats in poetry
rhythm	a regular, repeated pattern of sounds or movements

Examples:

- *Oh, I wish that you were mine.*
- *I think about you all the time.*





Learning Points

Modals for Suggestions, Necessity, and Possibility

You use modals when you want to express possibility, suggestions and necessity.

You use *may*, *might* and *could* to express possibility in the past and in the future.

**Might* suggests that something is less possible than *may*.

- might / might not + infinitive
- could / could not + infinitive
- may / may not + infinitive

Example:

You might be able to speak with him before work.

You could be kind and friendly when you approach him.

Should, could, might and **would** are used to express suggestions:

Example:

You should be direct with him.

That would be the best way to handle the situation.

The modal verbs **must**, **have to** and **have got to** show that something is necessary.

Must is the strongest of the three and is most common in writing.

*It **must** be very hard for him to speak to you.*

*You **have to** let him down softly.*

